



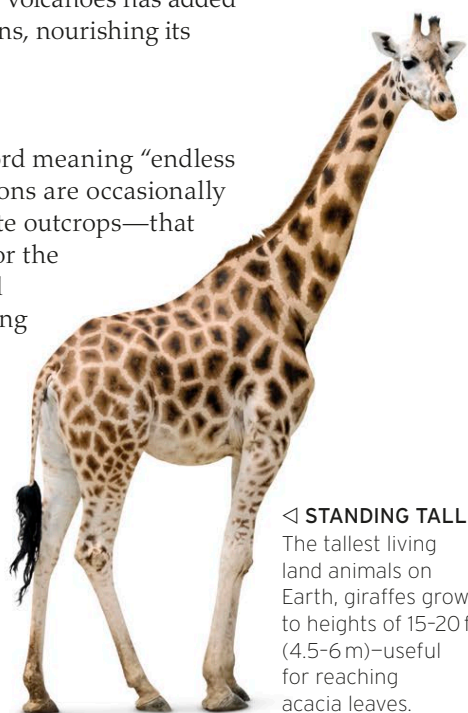
The Serengeti

The famous immense African grassland, the site of one of the most spectacular annual migrations on Earth

Covering 11,600 square miles (30,000 square km) across Kenya and Tanzania, the Serengeti lies near the equator and consists mainly of grassland in the southeast, open woodlands of acacia trees in the north, and a mix of grassland and acacias in the western regions. Ash from nearby volcanoes has added to the fertility of the region's rolling plains, nourishing its short, intermediate, and long grasses.

Mass migrations

"Serengeti" is derived from a Masai word meaning "endless plain," but even its vast grassland sections are occasionally broken up by kopjes—weathered granite outcrops—that not only provide much-needed shade for the savannas' wildlife species but also hold rainwater in rocky depressions, providing small water holes for animals. Hordes of wildlife, particularly herds of herbivores, are part of the fabric of the Serengeti. Each year, more than a million wildebeest and hundreds of thousands of zebras and gazelles come together to form a vast "super herd" in an amazing migration of 620 miles (1,000 km), following the seasonal rains that bring fresh grass and vital water supplies to this arid area of Africa.



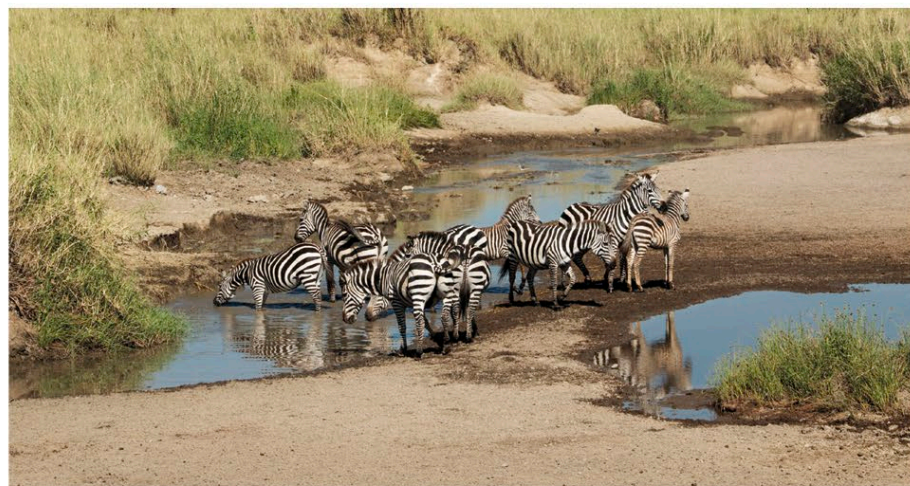
◁ STANDING TALL

The tallest living land animals on Earth, giraffes grow to heights of 15-20 ft (4.5-6 m)—useful for reaching acacia leaves.



△ NATURE'S RECYCLERS

Dung beetles provide waste removal in the Serengeti by rolling and burying dung to use as food and as a place to lay eggs.



△ SYMBOL OF THE SERENGETI

Acacias dominate parts of the Serengeti. Among the few trees found in the region, acacias provide food and vital shade for many animal species.

◁ WATER BREAK

Water holes provide a lifeline to migrating herbivores, such as zebras—but also for the carnivores that prey on them.